

planning to use its money to bail out these highly pampered babus.

J. AKSHOBHYA, Mysore

The crisis in Air India has not happened overnight. To put the entire blame on employees, saying 'how long can the government support without a change in employee mindset' is not quite correct. One tends to wonder what the ministers in charge were doing all this time.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, Thiruvananthapuram

Statue Frenzy

Megalomania is an ailment not alien to Indian politics but without doubt Madam Mayawati takes the cake ("Back to the Stone Age", July 13). How does Rs 2,000 crore spent from the state treasury for constructing the statues amount to "ideological empowerment of Dalits", as claimed by Mayawati? It is for the people to read the message and isolate such politicians from the system itself.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, Mumbai

The self-styled pseudo-messiah of the Dalits, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati, has cheated her own people. Let us hope the Supreme Court orders destruction of all the statues and Mayawati has to cough up the expenses incurred for the same from her kitty.

A. K. SHARMA, Chandigarh

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Frozen in Time

The unconscionable time taken by Justice Liberhan in submitting his report on the Babri Masjid demolition has ramifications beyond his brief ("Better Late Than Never" July 13). It shows that our judges would take their own time over one case as much as over several. Experience with other commissions of inquiry too bears this, though not matching

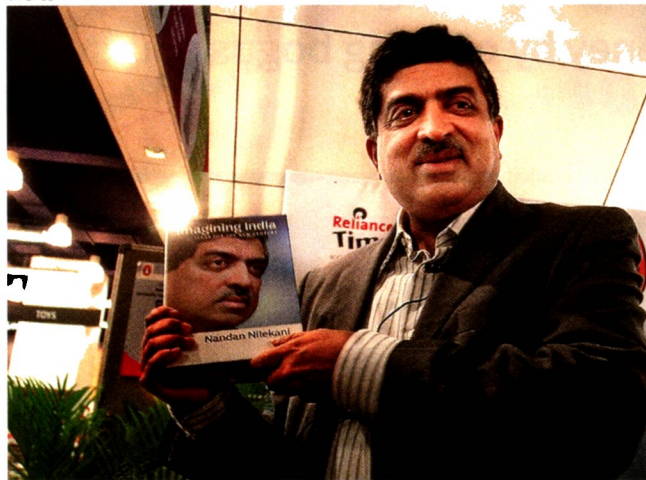
by one party, the state's 'progressive' image was tainted. Now I think the people of Bihar, at least from Musehri, may have some positive thoughts about Marathis. Such stories merit media attention, because people need to have good examples to follow.

SANJEEV KABEER, Delhi

Swift and Sure

It's ironical that our country has a greater sensitivity

MAIL TODAY



“The UID would be a litmus test for Nilekani to prove the bureaucrats wrong. The prime minister must help him deliver the goods rather than pressuring him to complete it in a year.”

BAL GOVIND, Noida

the drag of this one.

BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

Hail Harmony

Your Offtrack on IAS officer Ajit Joshi was an eye opener ("It Takes a Village", July 6). Last year, when north Indians were targeted in Maharashtra

towards racist violence when women in our country are being subjected to sexual assaults and rape ("Mind of a Rapist", July 6). Speedy justice and swift action should be taken to set women free from all these diabolic activities.

IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

SEPTEMBER 1-15, 1979

Laborious Progress

The Minorities Commission, like the religious groups it hopes to serve, has given rise to more than its share of controversies in its 20-month tenure. Set up in January last year, the commission has achieved little in terms of its exhaustive eight-point charter. Besides monitoring and overseeing the legal and constitutional safeguards for minorities, it is also charged with conducting studies on preventing discrimination, suggesting legal and welfare measures and acting as a clearing house for information on the conditions of the minorities. With an annual budget of Rs 12 lakh, a fleet of cars and other accoutrements of officialdom, the commission has so far produced four reports. Apart from the annual report, these pertain to the communal riots at Aligarh in Uttar Pradesh, Jamshedpur in Bihar and Pernampet in Tamil Nadu. But even these occupied very little of the commission's time. In the first six months of this year, the members kept themselves busy discussing the 'relative rights and powers of the Chairman vis-a-vis the Commission and the secretary'. **by Arul B. Louis**